Pre-construction checklist

Everything to have in place before breaking ground (contracts, approvals, insurance, documents, site set-up and safety), from the template pack's pre-construction checklist.

Project		Date	
Completed by		Signature	

Work through this before the first trade arrives. Approval and insurance names follow NSW usage (development consent or CDC, construction certificate, BASIX, home building compensation). Other states use different names for the same steps: see the state rules.

Contracts & Approvals

Item	Done	Notes
Building contract signed by all parties	☐	
Development consent / CDC obtained	☐	
Construction certificate issued	☐	
Home building compensation insurance in place	☐	
Deposit received	☐	
Builder licence current and valid	☐	
Public liability insurance current	☐	
Workers compensation insurance current	☐	

Design & Documentation

Item	Done	Notes
Approved plans on site	☐	
Engineering drawings received and reviewed	☐	
Specifications complete and issued	☐	
Soil / geotechnical report obtained	☐	
Survey plan obtained (boundaries, levels, setbacks)	☐	
Energy rating / BASIX certificate obtained	☐	
Bushfire assessment (if applicable)	☐	
Flood report (if applicable)	☐	

Site Preparation

Item	Done	Notes
Site inspection completed	☐	
Before You Dig Australia (BYDA) enquiry completed	☐	
Service locations marked on site	☐	
Tree protection measures in place (if applicable)	☐	
Sediment and erosion controls installed	☐	
Temporary fencing / hoarding installed	☐	
Site toilet ordered and delivered	☐	
Skip bin / waste management arranged	☐	
Temporary power connected or generator on site	☐	
Temporary water connected	☐	
Site sign installed (as per council requirements)	☐	

Safety & Compliance

Item	Done	Notes
Site safety management plan prepared	☐	
First aid kit on site	☐	
Fire extinguisher on site	☐	
Emergency contact list displayed	☐	
WHS notification to SafeWork (if required)	☐	
Asbestos inspection / report (demolition)	☐	
SWMS prepared for initial high-risk work	☐	

Neighbours & Access

Item	Done	Notes
Adjoining owners notified	☐	
Party wall agreements (if applicable)	☐	
Site access confirmed (driveways, crane access)	☐	
Council road / footpath permits (if required)	☐	
Parking arrangements confirmed	☐	

Trades & Program

Item	Done	Notes
Construction program prepared	☐	
Key trades booked with start dates confirmed	☐	
Long-lead items identified and ordered	☐	
Client selections required before lock-up identified	☐	